MIL-C-43397B

24 August 1976

SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-43397A
26 May 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARDBOARD AND PAPER, EMBOSSING, TOP

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of embossing material for use in sign making (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The embossing materials covered by this specification shall be of two types as follows (see 6.2):

Type I - Embossing top paper - 12 inches long by 10 inches wide
Type II - Cardboard - 44 inches long by 28 inches wide or 44 inches long by 14 inches wide (see 6.2)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-T-90	-	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive (Cellophane and Cellulose Acetate).
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Command, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 9310

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized and Containerized Unit Loads, 40" X 48" Pallets, Skids, Runners or Pallet-Type Base.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

TECHNICAL ASSOCIATION OF THE PULP AND PAPER INDUSTRY

(TAPPI) PUBLICATIONS:

T402os-70 - Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres For Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets, and Related Products
T403os-76 - Bursting Strength of Paper
T410os-68 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard
T411os-76 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard

(Copies of TAPPI Testing Methods may be obtained from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Dept., 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

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UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Type I.

3.1.1 Material. The embossing top paper shall consist of a sheet of paper evenly and uniformly coated on one side with a heat sensitive adhesive.

3.1.2 Color, gloss and finish. The color, gloss and surface finish on the side opposite the heat sensitive adhesive shall match that of the standard sample furnished with the invitation for bids. The embossing top paper shall be furnished in the color specified (see 6.2).

3.1.3 Physical properties. The embossing top paper shall conform to the requirements of table I, when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

TABLE I. Physical requirements for type I embossing paper

Basis weight, 24 x 36 - 500, pounds	115 ± 10
Thickness, inch	
Maximum	0.0075
Minimum	0.0055
Bursting strength, points, minimum	23

3.1.4 Blocking resistance. The embossing top paper shall not block to the extent that sheets cannot be separated without surface pick, delamination or loss of coating when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.1.5 Embossing quality. The paper shall emboss satisfactorily without surface cracking, scuffing, tearing, delamination or sticking to the embossing die. The embossed letters shall firmly adhere to the backing cardboard so that they cannot be separated when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

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3.1.6 Workmanship. The embossing paper shall have clean cut edges and shall be clean and free from cuts, tears or holes.

3.2 Type II.

* 3.2.1 Material. The cardboard shall consist of a facing sheet, a filler board and a backing sheet. The finished cardboard shall contain not less than 10 percent by weight of reclaimed fiber. Reclaimed fiber is fiber collected from solid waste or waste collected as a result of an agricultural or manufacturing process, but not including material generated from and reused within the plant as a part of its own papermaking process. The papermaking process is the manufacturing process of producing paper up to and including the cutting of the machine reel into smaller rolls or sheets.

3.2.1.1 Facing sheet. The facing sheet shall be not less than 0.005 inches thick and shall be made from 100 percent bleached chemical wood fiber.

3.2.1.2 Backing sheet. The backing sheet shall be not less than 0.004 inches thick and shall be of sufficient contrast to the color of the facing sheet to readily establish the intended working surface.

3.2.1.3 Filler board. The filler board shall be of sufficient thickness and basis weight so that when combined with the backing and facing sheet the end item meets the requirements specified in table II.

TABLE II. Physical requirements for type II cardboard

Basis weight, pounds/1000 sq. ft.	220 ± 20
Thickness, inch	0.065 ± 0.005

3.2.2 Pasting. Facing and backing sheets shall be securely pasted to the filler board throughout the entire area of contact and shall remain intact when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.2.3 Physical properties. The cardboard shall conform to the requirements of table II when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.2.4 Color and finish. The facing sheet shall compare favorably with the standard sample with respect to color and surface finish. The color shall be as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.5 Embossing quality. The cardboard shall emboss satisfactorily without cracking, breaking or ply separation when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

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3.2.6 Workmanship. The cardboard shall be clean, with clean cut edges and free from surface cracks or scuffs.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

* 4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

* 4.2.1.1 Testing of the components. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance to the contracting officer stating that the fiber content and thickness of the facing sheet and the thickness of the backing sheet conform to the requirements stated in 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.1.2, as applicable, when determined in accordance with TAPPI Standard T411os-76.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

* 4.3.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for defects set forth in the applicable subparagraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) in 4.3.1.4. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot of the end items for examination of visual, dimensional, and count defects. The lot size for the purpose of determining the sample size, in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of sheets for examination under 4.3.1.1, 4.3.1.2 and 4.3.1.3.

4.3.1.1 Examination for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one sheet of top paper or cardboard, as applicable. Both sides of the material shall be examined.

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Examine	Defect
Appearance	Color, gloss and formation, as applicable, of the embossing top paper or cardboard does not compare favorably to the standard sample. Color not as specified.
Workmanship	Edges not clean cut; ragged; crushed. Any cut, tear or hole. Any surface cracks or scuffs.
Coating	
Type I	Not evenly adhesive coated on one side. Coated both sides.
Facing and backing	
Type II	Not sufficient contrast to establish working surface.

4.3.1.2 Examination for defects in dimensions. The sample unit for this examination shall be one sheet of top paper or cardboard, as applicable.

Examine	Defect
Length and width	Varies from dimension specified by more than ± 1/8 inch.

4.3.1.3 Examination for count. The lot shall be unacceptable if the average count per individual package for all packages examined is less than specified.

4.3.1.4 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for examination. The inspection levels, for determining the sample size, and acceptable quality levels (AQL's), expressed in defects per one hundred units shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQL
4.3.1.1	I	2.5
4.3.1.2	S-3	2.5
4.3.1.3	S-2	-

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* 4.3.2 Testing of the end item. All tests shall be conducted under standard conditions specified in Method T402os-70 of TAPPI. The test sample unit shall consist of a sufficient number of sheets to provide not less than 1000 square inches of material. Not more than one sample unit shall be drawn from any one package. The lot size shall be expressed in units of sheets of one type and size. The sample size shall be selected in accordance with the sampling plan below. Test results shall include all values upon which the results are based and there shall be no failure to meet the sample unit or lot average requirements. In addition, the contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance stating that the cardboard contains the minimum amount of recycled fiber specified in 3.2.1.

Sampling plan

Lot size (Sheets)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 or more	5

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INSTRUCTIONS FOR TESTING

* TABLE III

CHARACTERISTIC	Specification Reference		Requirements Applicable To		Number Determinations Per Unit	Results Reported As		Inspect Level	AQL
	Requirement	Test Method	Individ Unit	Lot Aver		Pass or Fail	Numerically to Nearest		
Type I									
Basis weight	Table I	T410os-68 (*)		X	1	-	pound		
Thickness	Table I	T411os-76 (*)		X	20	-	0.0001 inch		
Bursting strength	Table I	T403os-76 (*)		X	20 (10 on each side)	-	point		
Block resistance	3.1.4	4.4.1	X	-	1	X	-		
Embossing quality	3.1.5	4.4.2	X	-	1	X	-		
Type II									
Basis weight	Table II	T410os-68 (*)	-	X	1	-	pound		
Thickness	Table II	T411os-76 (*)	-	X	20	-	0.0001 inch		
Pasting	3.2.2	4.4.3	X	-	1	X	-		
Embossing quality	3.2.5	4.4.2	X	-	1	X	-		

(*) Indicates TAPPI standard designation.

AMXRE Form 598
8 February 1965

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4.3.3 Inspection of packaging.

4.3.3.1 Examination for preservation - packaging, packing, and marking. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation - packaging, packing, and marking complies with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be as listed below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, except that it shall not be closed. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery that have not been palletized shall be examined for defects of closure. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of interior packages per shipping container more or less than required.

* 4.3.3.2 Examination for palletization. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be as listed below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimension	Length, width or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Not as specified. Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.

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4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Blocking resistance. Cut 10 specimens 2 by 2 inches. Stack the specimens evenly with the adhesive side down. Place the stack on a clean, dry, flat surface and place a weight on the stack so that a pressure of 0.25 ± 0.05 p.s.i. is evenly distributed over the 4 square inch area. Place the weighted stack in an oven maintained at 100° ± 2°F. for one hour. After this period has elapsed take the stack from the oven, remove the weight, and allow the specimens to cool for 15 minutes at 73° ± 3.5°F. and 50 ± 2 percent relative humidity. After the cooling period, rapidly separate the specimens and examine for conformance to 3.1.4.

4.4.2 Embossing quality. Emboss the top paper and cardboard with the letters A, B, D, E, G, O, P, Q and R in the 1/2 inch size on an Embossograph machine in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions. Iron the embossed letters as specified in the instructions. Examine the embossed sheet for evidence of surface cracking, scuffing, tearing, delamination or die sticking of the top paper and evidence of cracking, breaking or ply separation of the carboard.

4.4.2.1 Firmly affix a 1-inch wide strip of cellophane tape conforming to type I, class A of L-T-90 over the embossed letters. Remove the tape from the embossed area by rapidly pulling the unaffixed end away from the letters. To be considered satisfactory, the letters shall not be pulled from the cardboard with the removal of the tape. Picking of the top surface of the embossing paper by the tape shall not constitute a failure.

4.4.3 Pasting. Facing sheets shall be stripped manually from the cardboard. To be considered satisfactory the facing sheet shall remain intact and fiber from the board shall be continuously distributed over the pasted area.

* 5. PACKAGING

* 5.1 Preservation - packaging. Preservation - packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A.

* 5.1.1.1 Type I. One hundred sheets of embossing top paper of one color only shall be preserved - packaged in a folding paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III, type G, class 1 of PPP-B-566; setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676; or fiberboard box conforming to style OPF, type CF (variety SW), class domestic, grade optional of PPP-B-636. Inside dimensions of each interior box shall approximate 12 inches in length, 10 inches in width, and 3/4 inch in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Box closure shall be secured with 2-inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45.

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* 5.1.1.2 Type II. Fifty sheets of cardboard of one color and size only shall be evenly stacked and completely wrapped in 40-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be secured with 2-inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade C of PPP-T-45.

5.1.2 Level C. Embossing top paper and cardboard shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The contractor may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing.

* 5.2.1.1 Type I. Two thousand sheets of embossing top paper of one color only preserved - packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat 2 in length, 1 in width, and 10 in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 20-1/2 inches in length, 12-1/4 inches in width, and 10 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.1.2 Type II. Fifty sheets 44 x 28 or one hundred sheets 44 x 14 of cardboard of one color only, preserved - packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style FTC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15C of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat one in depth for 44 x 28 sheet and two in depth for 44 x 14 sheet within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 44-1/2 by 28-1/2 by 3-1/4 inches for the 44 x 28 sheet and 44-1/2 by 14-1/2 by 6-1/2 inches for the 44 x 14 sheet. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B packing.

* 5.2.2.1 Type I. Two thousand sheets of embossing top paper of one color only, preserved - packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat 2 in length, 1 in width, and 10 in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 20-1/2 inches in length, 12-1/4 inches in width, and 10 inches in depth.

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Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.2.2 Type II. Fifty sheets 44 x 28 or one hundred sheets 44 x 14 of cardboard of one color only, preserved - packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style FTC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 350 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat, one in depth for the 44 x 28 and two in depth for the 44 x 14 sheet, within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 44-1/2 inches by 28-1/2 inches by 3-1/4 inches for the 44 x 28 sheet and 44-1/2 inches by 14-1/2 inches by 6-1/2 inches for the 44 x 14 sheet. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.2.3 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping containers specified in 5.2.2.1 and 5.2.2.2 shall be grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard boxes fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

* 5.2.3 Level C packing. Embossing top paper and cardboard, preserved - packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), embossing top paper and cardboard, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147 the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, interior packages, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Interior packages containing type II sheets of cardboard shall not require marking.

5.4.1 Precautionary marking. Each interior package and shipping container containing type I sheets of embossing top paper shall be marked with the precautionary instructions:

"STORE IN A COOL PLACE"

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6. NOTES

* 6.1 Intended use. The embossing materials covered by this specification are for making signs.

The type I embossed top paper is available in the following colors:

Red	Green	Black
Yellow	Purple	White
Blue	Orange	Metallic gold
Dark blue		

The type II cardboard is available in the following colors:

Red	Black
Yellow	White
Blue	Gray

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type, size, and color required (see 1.2, 3.1.2 and 3.2.4).
(c) Selection of the applicable levels of preservation - packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.3).
(e) When palletization is required (see 5.3).

* 6.3 Changes from previous issue. The outside margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, corrections, modifications, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-C-43397B - Cardboard and Paper, Embossing, Top

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

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